

Oregon's 1st Congressional District

2026 VOTER GUIDE

Barbara Kahl *vs.* Suzanne Bonamici

ECONOMY

ENERGY

IMMIGRATION

SCHOOLS

HEALTHCARE

FEDERAL ACCOUNTABILITY

GENERAL ELECTION • NOVEMBER 3, 2026

Beaverton • Hillsboro • West Portland • Forest Grove • Astoria • Tillamook • St. Helens

Fourteen years in Washington. One new challenger.
Compare the record.

14

14 Years Creates a Record.

BARBARA KAHL

Veterinarian • Former Intel Employee • Fourth-Generation Oregonian

Barbara Kahl is a fourth-generation Oregonian who graduated from Hillsboro High School and earned degrees in animal science and chemistry before becoming a veterinarian.^[1]

She has spent nearly 20 years operating a mobile veterinary practice across the district and previously worked at Intel.^[1]

In 2022, Kahl was recruited to serve as chief veterinarian for American Samoa, where she helped establish the territory's first animal-control unit and drafted its Veterinary Practice Act.^[1]

Her stated priorities are:

- Economic growth
- Timber and ports
- Less regulatory burden
- School choice
- Education funding that follows the student
- Lower healthcare costs
- Federal accountability
- Term limits^[1]

The question is not whether she has experience.
It's what that record shows after fourteen years.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Member of Congress Since 2012

Suzanne Bonamici entered Congress through a 2012 special election and serves on the House Education and Workforce Committee and House Science, Space and Technology Committee.

Her recent political and congressional record includes:

- Calls for less ICE funding^[3]
- Greater federal education funding^[3]
- Nay votes on the Laken Riley Act in 2024 and 2025
- A Nay vote on H.Con.Res.9, a 2023 resolution “denouncing the horrors of socialism”
- Climate-focused policy^[3]
- Immigration legislation and opposition to additional ICE detention capacity in Oregon^{[3][5]}
- Water-power and energy research legislation^[4]
- 2026 Oregon Working Families Party endorsement/cross-nomination^[2]

CD-1 makes things.

Semiconductors in Washington County. Freight through the Columbia. Timber from Northwest Oregon. Tourism and fishing on the coast. Small businesses throughout the district.

Federal decisions on permitting, energy, land use, workforce policy, and regulation can affect the businesses operating here.

BARBARA KAHL

Barbara Kahl's economic argument starts with production.

Her stated priorities include:

- **Timber supply.**
- **Strong Columbia and coastal ports.**
- **Less red tape on small businesses.**
- **Workforce investment connected to real jobs.**
- **Lower regulatory costs for builders and employers.**^[1]

Her experience includes both Intel and navigating federal and state veterinary regulation.^[1]

Make it easier to build, grow, ship and hire.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici's economic agenda emphasizes STEAM education, expanded federal government investment, climate-related infrastructure and other federal programs.^[3]

She has spent fourteen years representing a district containing one of Oregon's most important manufacturing and technology corridors.^[2]

After 14 years, her record is everywhere to analyse where she stands.

CD-1 needs power.

Who pays for the next megawatt?

Homes need electricity. Intel and other manufacturers need reliable electricity. And rapidly expanding data centers and AI infrastructure can create significant additional electricity demand.

In January 2026, Bonamici introduced H.R. 7129, the Water Power Research and Development Reauthorization Act, with Rep. Nick Begich.^[4]

The legislation addresses hydropower, marine energy and pumped-storage research, including integration with large electrical loads such as data centers.^[4]

Bonamici's 2025 voting record also includes Nay votes on:

- H.R. 3632 — Power Plant Reliability
- H.R. 3628 — State Planning for Reliability and Affordability
- H.R. 1949 — Unlocking Domestic LNG
- H.R. 1047 — GRID Power
- H.R. 3015 — National Coal Council^[5]

BARBARA KAHL

Kahl argues that large-scale data-center demand should not leave households and manufacturers carrying disproportionate grid costs.

She has called for greater scrutiny of where regional energy is routed and how large-load growth affects existing users.^[1]

Her point is “audit first”:

- Where is the power going?
- Who is creating the new demand?
- Who is paying for the infrastructure?

The energy record clearly needs a closer look.

Immigration: examine the votes.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici’s own 2026 campaign published the headline:

“NO MORE ICE FUNDING.”^[3]

Another campaign message states:

“Schools need more funding. ICE needs less.”^[3]

Laken Riley Act — Congressional Record

2024 • 2025

Her congressional record includes:

2024 — Laken Riley Act (H.R. 7511): NAY

2025 — Laken Riley Act (H.R. 29): NAY

2025 — Senate Laken Riley Act (S.5): NAY

YEA

263

NAY • BONAMICI AMONG 156

156

The final 2025 legislation passed the House 263–156. Bonamici was among the 156 members voting Nay.

• BONAMICI NAY • FINAL 2025 VOTE

Her record also includes opposition to additional ICE detention capacity in Oregon^[3] and votes against other immigration-enforcement or Homeland Security measures documented in the guide’s sources.

In January 2026, Bonamici also called for President Trump’s impeachment and criticized his administration’s immigration enforcement.^[7]

BARBARA KAHL

Kahl’s published approach emphasizes border enforcement, spending constraints and limits on government benefits for people who do not qualify.

Two different approaches to immigration and enforcement.

Fund the student or fund the system?

Oregon's education outcomes remain a major concern.

BARBARA KAHL

Kahl supports:

- Phonics
- Teacher freedom
- Vocational pathways
- School choice
- Funding that follows the student^[1]

Her education argument is focused on student outcomes and giving families more control over where education dollars go.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici serves on the House Education and Workforce Committee and is Ranking Member of its Early Childhood, Elementary, and Secondary Education Subcommittee.

She advocates greater federal government education spending and federal involvement in education policy.

Her campaign has also paired education funding with immigration-enforcement spending:

“Schools need more funding. ICE needs less.”

Bonamici has made education a major focus of her congressional work. Voters can compare that record with Oregon's current education outcomes.

The policy questions

- How much responsibility should Washington have for education?
- Should additional federal spending be the priority, or should funding follow students and families?
- What outcomes should accompany additional government spending?

Healthcare: who deals with the price?

Barbara Kahl is a veterinarian and has spent nearly two decades operating a clinical practice.^[1] Her healthcare argument starts with a basic problem:

Expanding coverage does not automatically make the underlying care less expensive.

BARBARA KAHL

Kahl emphasizes:

- Hospital costs
- Drug prices
- Keeping independent practices viable
- Examining costs before creating new taxes
- Scrutinizing the financing behind government healthcare proposals^[1]

Fix the price before moving the bill.

CD-1 voters can examine which problem each candidate proposes to address first.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici frames healthcare as a moral and access issue and supports a larger public role in healthcare coverage.^[3]

Her campaign has argued against increasing healthcare costs to finance tax reductions for wealthy Americans.^[3]

Coverage and cost are not the same question.

What has Bonamici done with the seat?

Bonamici originally entered Congress in 2012 after a career that included consumer-protection law and service in the Oregon Legislature.^[2]

Fourteen years later, her public record includes:

- “No more ICE funding.”^[3]
- “Schools need more funding. ICE needs less.”^[3]
- Calls for President Trump’s impeachment.^[7]
- Working Families Party cross-nomination.^[2]
- A 99.66 ProgressivePunch rating for 2025–26.^[6]
- 100% on ProgressivePunch’s “crucial votes.”^[6]
- Voted Nay on the Laken Riley Act.
- Voted Nay on H.R. 9576, the National Fraud Enforcement Division Act of 2026, on September 16, 2026.
- Voted Nay on H.Con.Res.9, the 2023 House resolution “denouncing the horrors of socialism.”
- 2026 Oregon Working Families Party endorsement/cross-nomination.

Those are measurable elements of the incumbent’s current political record.

Voters can decide whether that record still matches CD-1.

The difference is very clear.

ISSUE	BARBARA KAHL	SUZANNE BONAMICI
Economy	Production + ports + timber + fewer regulatory barriers	Federal government investment + climate-related infrastructure
Energy	Reliability + audits + cost allocation	Federal energy research + climate-focused policy
Immigration	Border enforcement	Less ICE funding + voted Nay on Laken Riley Act
Schools	Choice + funding follows student	Greater federal government education spending
Healthcare	Lower underlying prices	Greater federal government role in coverage
Federal Role	Less regulation + accountability	Broader federal government programs/investment
Political Record	Challenger	Member of Congress since 2012

Fourteen years makes the comparison possible.

Kahl doesn’t have a congressional voting record.

Bonamici does.

That means voters can examine what Bonamici has voted for, what she has opposed, what she says today, and how those priorities compare with Kahl’s stated alternative.

Fourteen years is long enough to have a record.

BARBARA KAHL

- Veterinarian.
- Former Intel employee.
- Fourth-generation Oregonian.
- Former chief veterinarian for American Samoa.

Her priorities:

1. • **Production**
2. • **Ports**
3. • **Timber**
4. • **Reliable energy**
5. • **School choice**
6. • **Healthcare affordability**
7. • **Federal accountability**^[1]

SUZANNE BONAMICI

- Member of Congress since 2012
- House Education and Workforce Committee member

Her recent record includes:

1. • “No more ICE funding” campaign message
2. • Voted Nay on the Laken Riley Act
3. • Voted Nay on H.R. 9576, the National Fraud Enforcement Division Act of 2026
4. • Voted Nay on H.Con.Res.9, “Denouncing the horrors of socialism”
5. • Supports increased federal government education spending
6. • Oregon Working Families Party’s 2026 CD-1 candidate/endorsee
7. • Climate and federal energy initiatives
8. • Alignment with progressive voting blocs^{[2][3][4][5]}

Read it.
Compare it.
Decide whether it still represents CD-1.

LEARN MORE ABOUT BARBARA KAHL → [DRKAHLFORCONGRESS.COM](https://drkahlforcongress.com)

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Sources & References

[1] **Dr. Barbara Kahl for Congress** — Campaign Platform and Priorities. drkahlforcongress.com, drkahloregon.com

[2] **Candidate / biographical and election records** — Ballotpedia; Bonamici congressional/campaign materials; 2026 election records. ballotpedia.org/Suzanne_Bonamici

[3] **Suzanne Bonamici campaign website** and latest-updates archive — including ICE, education/ICE and climate statements.

[4] **Congress.gov** — CREC-2026-01-16.pdf — H.R. 7129, Water Power Research and Development Reauthorization Act.

[5] **Vote Smart** — 2025–26 roll-call records, including the energy, immigration and appropriations votes identified in the research.

[6] **ProgressivePunch** — 2025–26 House scores. progressivepunch.org/scores.htm

[7] **Rep. Suzanne Bonamici congressional office** — January 21, 2026 statement.

INFORMATION & SOURCES DISCLAIMER

Candidate positions, statements, voting records, policy information, and other factual claims in this guide are based on publicly available information and cited sources reviewed as of **September 21, 2026**. Candidate positions, campaign materials, websites, voting records, and policy proposals may be updated or changed after publication. Readers are encouraged to review the cited sources and current candidate materials for the most recent information.

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